

TACTICAL REVOLUTION

After a 12-year hiatus, the tournament returned for its fourth edition in Brazil, where the hosts were beaten in the final by a tactically superior Uruguay. The following editions ushered in a quiet tactical revolution, marked by sharper game awareness and a gradual shift away from the pyramid and WM formations that had defined the 1930s.

Several ideas came to the forefront, with Hungary taking the concept of a 'False 9' to a whole new level in the 1954 edition, before England reigned on home soil in 1966 by abandoning wingers for midfield rigidity. Brazil's dazzling dribblers continued to thrill with attacking verve, yielding three World Cups in four editions. The 1970 edition was, perhaps, the pinnacle of the *Jogo Bonito* philosophy, with the side scoring 19 goals.

In the 70s, Johan Cruyff's Netherlands brought forth the 'Total Football' revolution, which has left a lasting impression on the game.

BRAZIL 1950



The silence of the Maracana: Alcides Ghiggia of Uruguay scores what proved to be the match-winner in the deciding fixture of the final round against Brazil at the Maracana Stadium in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, on July 16, 1950. The result, 2-1, helped Uruguay lift its second World Cup title. AP